Changes since this edition · Casting and Locations Book v1.1

This is the Casting and Locations Book v1 with this page added in front (v1.1, 6 October 2026). The pages that follow are unchanged and were written on 4 October. Where they differ from what is below, this page and Cast and Locations Spec v1.2 are current. Sources: Master v4.2 LOCKED, Script Breakdown v3.1, Look Spec v1.3, Shot List v1.3, the Director's Playbook (Katz).

COVER · SOURCES

This edition: Based on Master v4.1 LOCKED, Script Breakdown v2 and Look Book v1.1.
Now: Master v4.2 LOCKED, Script Breakdown v3.1, Look Book v1.2 and Look Spec v1.3.

DANIEL · HANDS

This edition: LEFT hand into his coat pocket at 'They won't believe me'.
Now: LEFT hand into his coat pocket after "They won't believe me. They'll believe the woman who took the call." (script order), out empty after the confession.

POLICE STATION (SCENE 12)

This edition: Lobby only; outside: a wet, still city street, brick facades, gray sky.
Now: Script v4.2 adds the exterior (12A): a low two-storey stone precinct house, stand-alone on its own corner, a flag hanging still over the entrance, three patrol cars nose-in at the side with light bars off, lit glass doors, across a wide, wet, empty street at dawn. The lobby is unchanged.

CARRIED INTO STEPS 5 AND 7

This edition: Design the skyline end frame; use the approved layouts; include the phone beats.
Now: Done at step 5 (Shot List v1.3, Storyboard Book v3.2). The step 7 tests listed on the last page still stand; add the precinct exterior reference (1 image) and 12A, 13A, 13B.

DISPATCH CENTER (SCENES 1, 8)

This edition: Colleagues: back rows, dim, out of focus, backs turned.
Now: Colleagues in the rows behind her, dim and out of focus, faces never readable. Her console has two monitors at the console ends (her centre line is open for the frontal setups); key = her right monitor (the active call), front-right.

HALCYON GARAGE, LEVEL FOUR

This edition: The stairwell door is inside the glass stair tower at the far west end.
Now: The stairwell door is on the stair tower's north face, at the far west end (forced by the geometry at step 5); Claire stops about 7 m inside the fire door (x 73, y 7.9); the red phone lies halfway between her and Daniel.

CLAIRE'S APARTMENT (SCENE 13)

This edition: Window: brick facades, fire escapes, a pale gray sky, drops on the glass.
Now: Window: brick facades, fire escapes, a spring sky; the sun comes through the window and the drops on the glass catch the sun. Script v4.2 adds 13A (her street in early spring after a shower, four passers-by, ONE WEEK LATER) and 13B (closer, level with her window, a faint figure at the table).

STEP 4 · CASTING AND LOCATION SCOUTING

TAP TWICE

CASTING AND LOCATIONS BOOK · V1

Based on Master v4.1 LOCKED, Script Breakdown v2 and Look Book v1.1 · 4 October 2026
Written by Mohammed Helal · 2.33:1 · 24 fps · cast locked v1 · location layouts approved 4 Oct



What step 4 locks

Step 4 answers **who** is in the film and **where** it happens. Step 5 decides how each moment is shot, step 6 how long it runs, and step 7 tests that these choices hold up in the real lighting before the shoot.

Cast	Faces, builds, heights and Claire's exact blonde. Claire, Daniel and the Desk Officer are LOCKED v1 (face images in *Cast/*).
Locations	What each place is: its layout, entrances, fixed features, where people stand and look, and the geography of the night. Layouts approved 4 Oct 2026.
Not here	Hero props and wardrobe were designed in the look book (step 3). They get their camera tests at step 7. This book only places props within each set.
Change control	Locked with change control: everything is v1. Any change becomes v1.1, the reason is logged and the old version goes to Archive. Nothing changes silently.
Hard freeze	At the end of step 7, once the tests confirm the faces, the hair and the key sets in the scene lighting. After that a change means regenerating every shot it touches.

DECIDED 4 OCT 2026

- Casting images: lean pass (option B), Nano Banana Pro, 2K
- Claire: candidate C. Northern European, gray-blue eyes, real and tired, slim, ≈ 5'6"
- Claire's blonde: the copper-honey of candidate C (replaces 'dark honey')
- Daniel and the Desk Officer locked as generated
- Present day (2026), an unnamed older-built American city
- Dispatch: older concrete civic building, renovated glass entrance
- Garage: raw concrete, built in the 1970s, 6 open decks, stair tower on its left corner. Design reference = skyline plate v1
- Final skyline frame (scene 9 end): designed in the shot list (step 5), generated at step 7
- Train: present-day stainless-steel car, warm yellow interior, no markings
- Laundromat window: shuttered shops, one cool streetlamp, Daniel at the kerb
- Apartment: 3rd-floor walk-up, brick facades and fire escapes outside



CAST/CLAIRE MERCER - FACE LOCKED V1.PNG · NANO BANANA PRO · FLAT 18% GRAY

Claire Mercer · 34

LOCKED V1

Heritage	Northern European. Fair skin, neutral-warm undertone, matte; a light scatter of faint freckles across the nose and upper cheeks.
Face	Heart-shaped: wider forehead, softly full cheeks, narrow gently pointed chin. Faint fine lines at the outer eyes, a little shadow under the lower lids. Real, tired, quietly attractive.
Eyes	Wide-set, round-almond, gray-blue with a warmer ring at the pupil. A calm, direct gaze.
Nose and mouth	Small straight nose with a slightly upturned tip. Fuller lower lip, soft cupid's bow, natural muted rose.
Brows	Light, straight, a gentle lift at the tail.
Hair	Copper-honey blonde, shoulder length, slight natural wave, side part on her LEFT (see next page).
Build	Slim, average; ≈ 5'6" (half a head shorter than Daniel).
Make-up	None visible beyond an even complexion. The same base in every look; scene 8 is not de-aged.
Default	Neutral, composed, guarded. Every emotion played one degree quieter.

Prompt handle (with the face image attached): 'the woman from the attached reference'. Never write her name or age in a prompt.

Claire's blonde · copper-honey

DECIDED 4 OCT

Warm honey to light strawberry-blonde, as generated in the locked face. Shoulder length, a slight natural wave, side part on her LEFT. It replaces the look book's 'dark honey'.

PROMPT STRING (REPLACES LOOK BOOK RULE 1)

> Present: 'shoulder-length copper-honey blonde hair with a slight natural wave, side part on her left, worn loose, not tied'.
> Scene 8 only: 'copper-honey blonde hair neatly tied back in a low ponytail'.
> Always add: 'honey blonde, not red, not ginger'.

WET AND DRY

Dry	Look A (sc 1), B (sc 2), E (sc 13): true copper-honey, soft wave.
Damp	Look B (sc 3-4): ends darker, wave loosening.
Soaked	Look C (sc 5-11): darkens to deep bronze-brown, clumps, wave gone. Still reads lighter than the black background.
Dried at dawn	Look D (sc 12): lighter and frizzier, tangled. Shows time passing.

UNDER EACH LIGHTING STATE

Blue · L1 L2 L7	Cools toward a muted honey-beige. Good: separates her head from the dark.
Amber · L3 L4 L8	Turns copper-gold. Risk: reads as red hair. Keep hair highlights below the lamp peak; in scene 8 the warm gold is part of the 'younger' read.
Sodium · L9	Near monochrome orange; hair and skin merge. Separate by value (hair darker when soaked), not by colour.
Crimson · L5	Risk: merges into the crimson. Keep it soaked and dark; light her from the backlight, not the neon.
Fluorescent · L6 L10	The green spike can turn copper olive. Correct in the grade; never correct skin and the red phone together.
Dawn · L11 / Day · L12	True colour, desaturated at dawn. The hero red stays the only pure red.

Step 7 test: her hair in L3 amber and L10 green fluorescent, wet and dry.

Claire's looks by scene

The locked face carries every look. Wardrobe is from Look Book v1.1; hands, earbud and headset from the Continuity Tracker (Breakdown v2).

Look	Sc	Hair	Wardrobe	Wetness	Collar	Headset	Earbud (white)	Her phone
A	1	Dry, loose, side part left	Slate-gray button shirt, sleeves pushed up, dark trousers. Coat not seen.	Dry	—	On LEFT ear → unplugged, around neck	—	Face-up by keyboard
A-young	8	Dry, low ponytail, face open	Soft rust-ochre knit	Dry, warm-lit	—	On LEFT ear	—	—
B dry	2	Dry, loose	Navy wool coat (mid-thigh, no hood, no belt) over Look A; flat black boots	Dry under the canopy	Down	Around neck	In pocket	Pocket → RIGHT palm
B damp	3-4	Damp at the ends	As B; shoulders darkened	Damp	Down	Around neck	In pocket	RIGHT hand
C	5-11	Soaked, dark bronze, clumped	Coat soaked almost black-navy (#0F1520); wet shoes	Soaked	Down → UP from end of sc 6	Around neck (twisted in sc 6)	RIGHT ear sc 6-11 → pocket in sc 11	Pocket sc 5 → out on the footbridge (RIGHT)
D	12	Dried lighter, tangled, frizzy	Coat still dark with rain	Coat wet, hair dry	Down	Lifted off → on the counter	In pocket (unseen)	Not shown
E	13	Clean, loose	Plain soft gray knit; the navy coat on a chair	Dry	—	Gone (empty hook)	—	On the table → ear

Wardrobe images of each look on the locked face are made at step 7 (castkit outfit builds), not now.

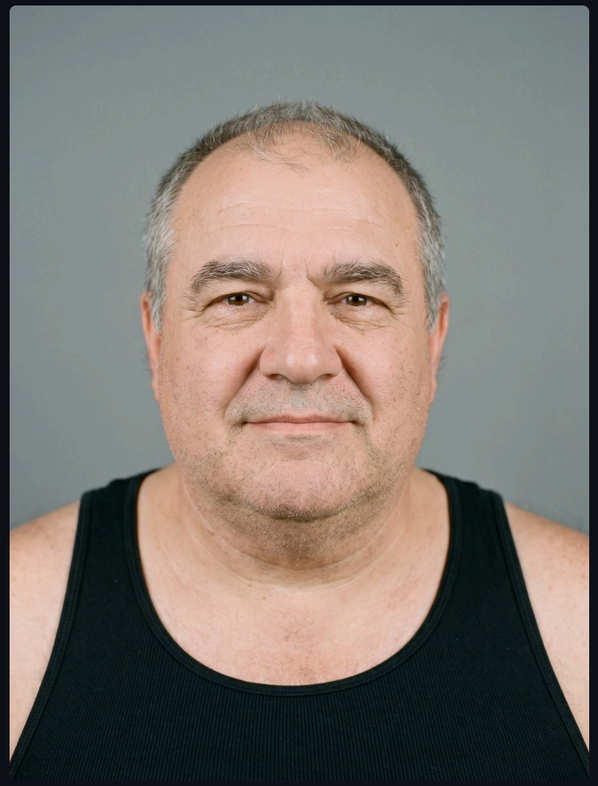


CAST/DANIEL - FACE LOCKED V1.PNG · USED ONCE: THE REVEAL (SC 11)

Daniel · 45

LOCKED V1

Face	Northern European. Long rectangular face, defined cheekbones, deep-set eyes, straight nose with a slight bump. Worn and gentle: the year shows under his eyes.
Hair	Full head of short dark brown hair; a slight recession at the temples and faint gray (accepted as generated). Never a hat. Prompt: 'full head of short dark hair, no hat'.
Beard	A few days of dark stubble with gray flecks at the chin.
Build	Tall and lean, ≈ 6'0". Long plain gray wool overcoat below the knee (#6E7378), dark trousers and shoes.
Silhouette rule	Always backlit by the scene's own practical until the reveal. Far and dark (sc 5), a reflection only (sc 6), the far end of the bridge (sc 10), deep shadow by the stairwell door (sc 11). 135 mm from her point of view.
Hands	Phone in his RIGHT hand; LEFT hand into his coat pocket at 'They won't believe me', out empty after the confession.
The reveal	He steps into the same strip light as hers, 50 mm medium. A man letting out a breath he has held for a year. Nods once, exits through the stairwell door.

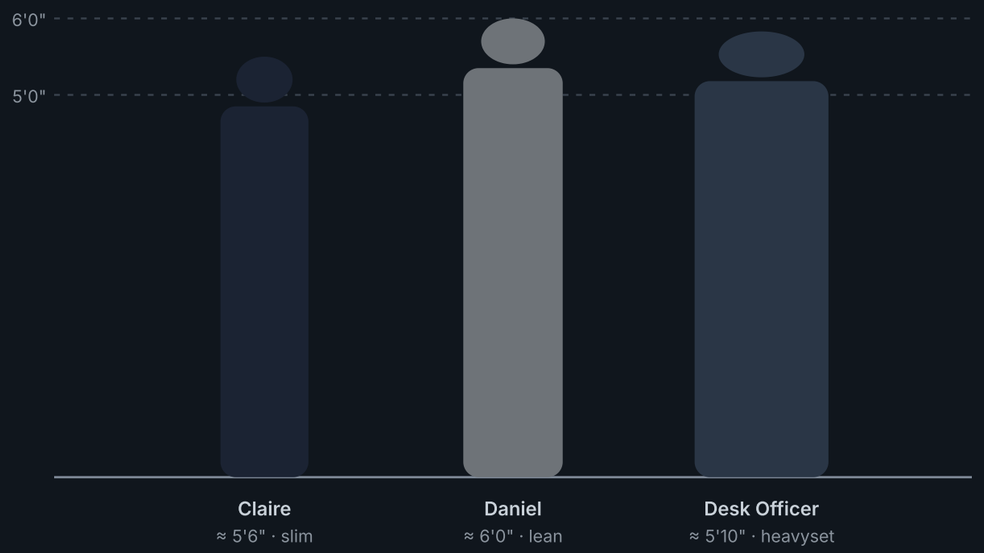


CAST/DESK OFFICER - FACE LOCKED V1.PNG

Desk Officer LOCKED V1

Face	Heavyset, a broad round face, small kind heavy-lidded brown eyes, short graying hair thinning at the crown. End of a night shift.
Uniform	Standard dark-navy police uniform shirt, no readable badge, patches or name bar. (Frame 11's black shirt is superseded.)
Action	Coffee in hand, filling in a log. Looks at the headset, then at her face; sets the coffee down. No lines.

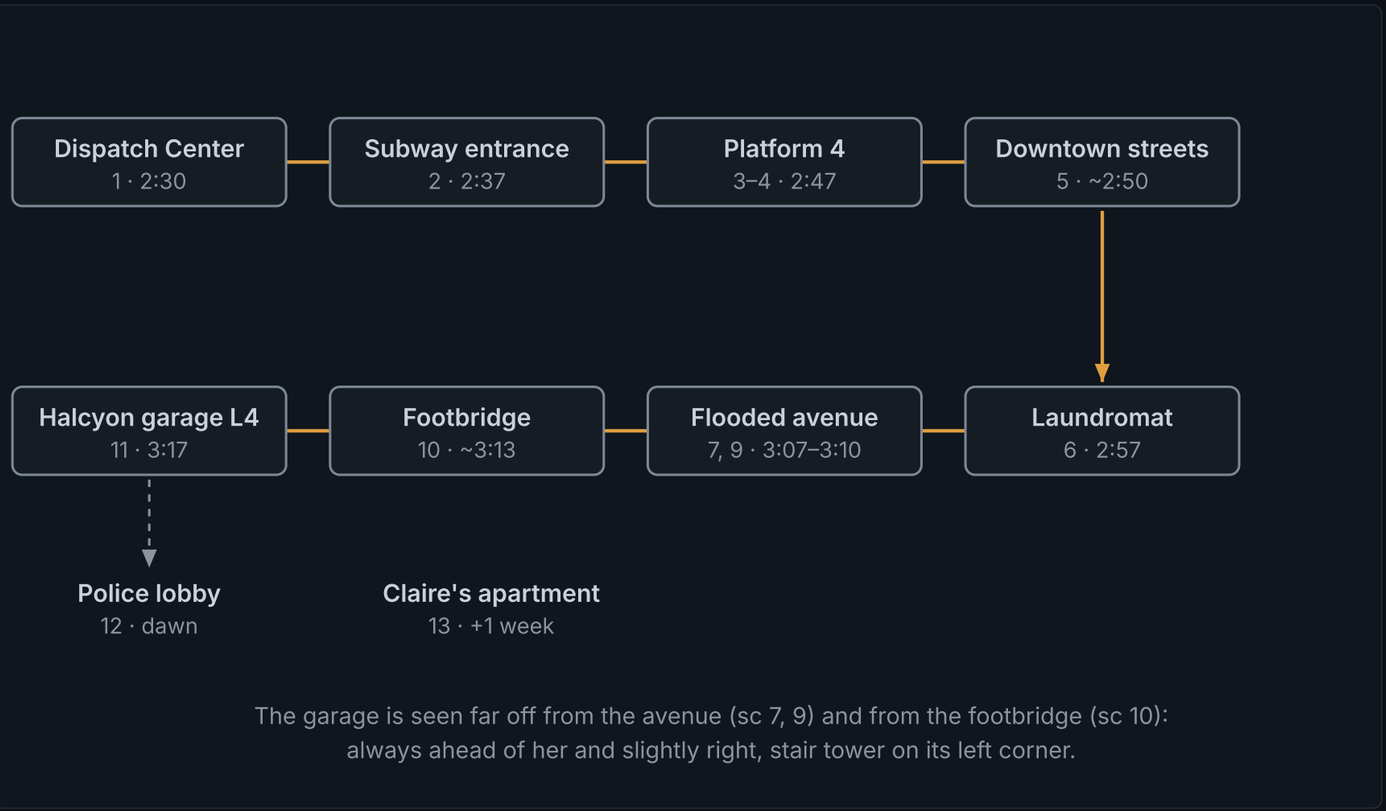
HEIGHTS APPROVED 4 OCT



The city · the route of the night

When	Present day, 2026. Smartphones, wireless earbuds, modern dispatch consoles, current cars.
Where	An unnamed American city built decades ago and still in daily use: tiled subway stations, brick and stone side streets, concrete civic buildings and garages.
Materials	Wet brick, stone, raw concrete, old tile, steel roller shutters, chain-link.
Rules	No readable text, signs, logos or route numbers anywhere. No suburban streets (frames 11 and 12 drifted suburban).
Same station	She leaves platform 4 by the same stairs she came down, back onto the street opposite the dispatch center, and turns left for home.

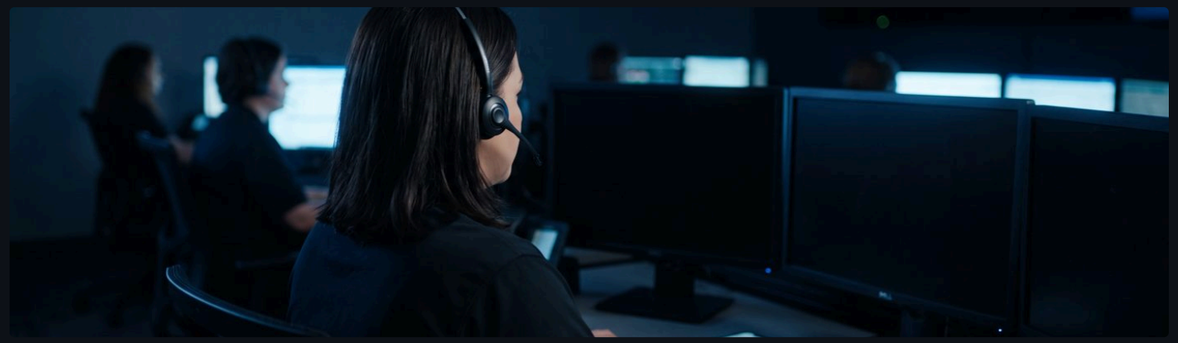
APPROVED 4 OCT Screen direction: in profile walking shots from scene 5 to 11 Claire moves screen left to right (toward the garage). The figure is always seen at the far end, near frame centre.



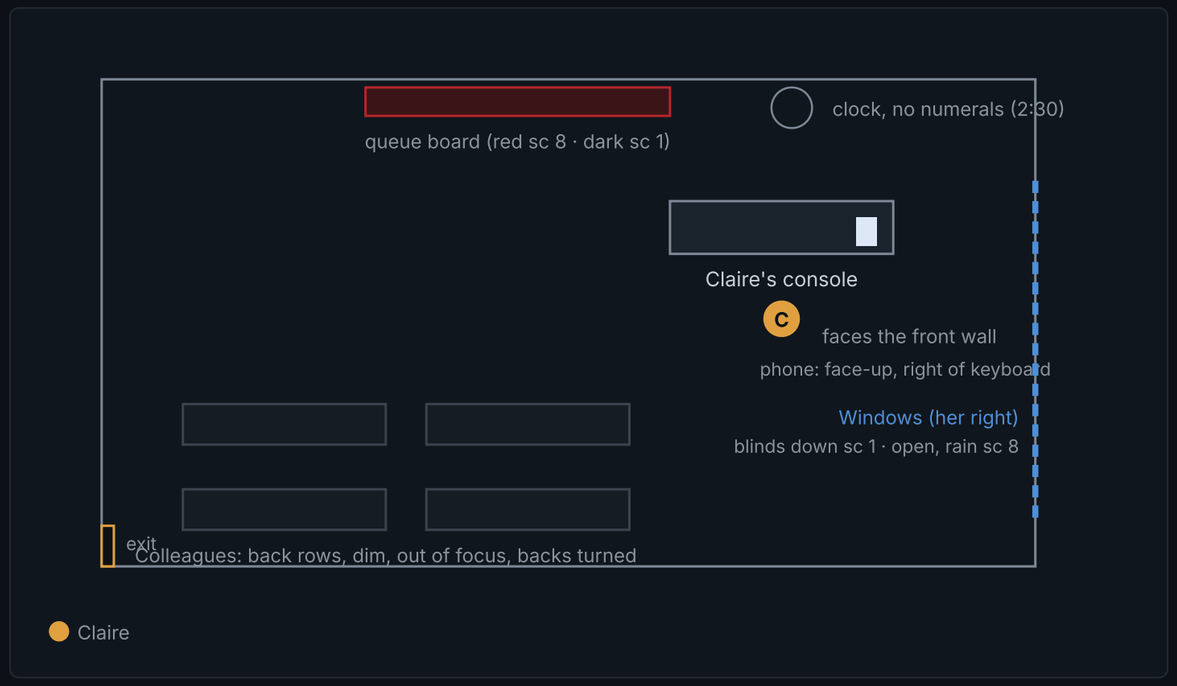
The garage is seen far off from the avenue (sc 7, 9) and from the footbridge (sc 10): always ahead of her and slightly right, stair tower on its left corner.

Dispatch Center

SCENES 1 · 8 APPROVED 4 OCT







FIX FROM THE MOOD FRAME

- Hair is now copper-honey (frames show dark hair): loose in sc 1, low ponytail in sc 8
- 'unbranded monitors' (frame 01 has a brand logo)
- No paper notes on cubicles; queue board blank (comp)

Room	Open dispatch floor, rows of consoles. One room, two lighting states: blue monitor (L1) / emergency amber (L8).
Claire	Front row, facing the front wall. Headset on her LEFT ear. Personal phone face-up to the right of her keyboard.
Front wall	Queue board (red, blank, comped) centred high; the analog clock (no numerals) to its right, above her console.
Windows	Along her right side. Blinds down in scene 1 (room black between screens); open with rain in scene 8.

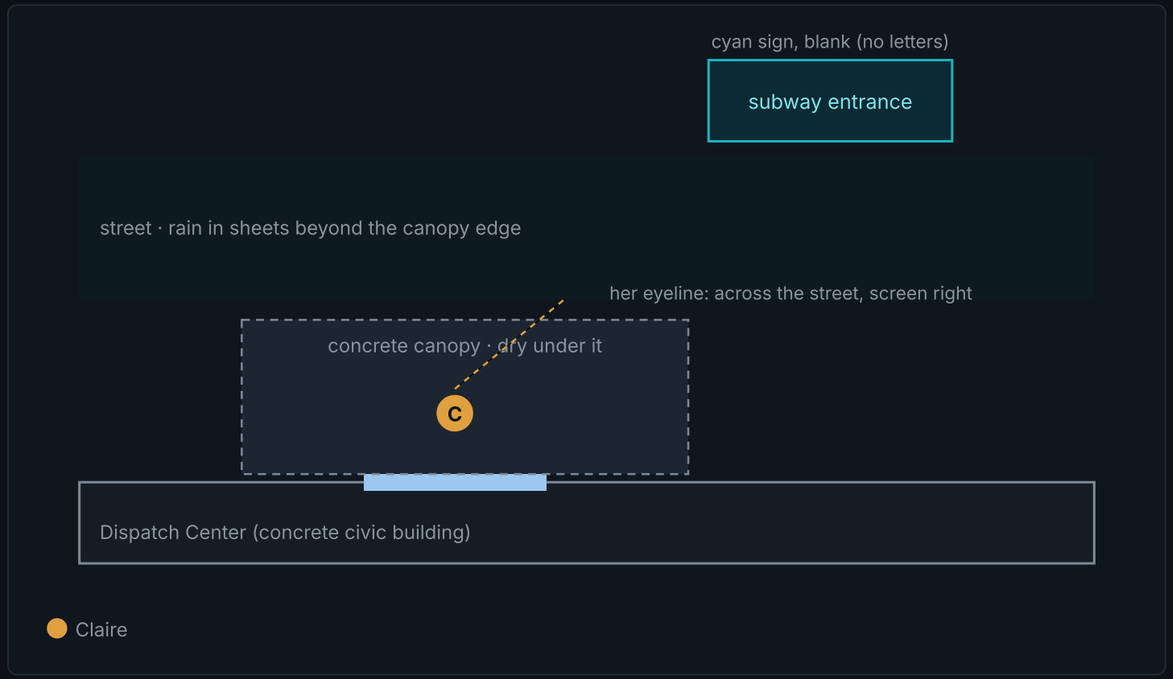
Dispatch Center entrance

SCENE 2 APPROVED 4 OCT



FIX FROM THE MOOD FRAME

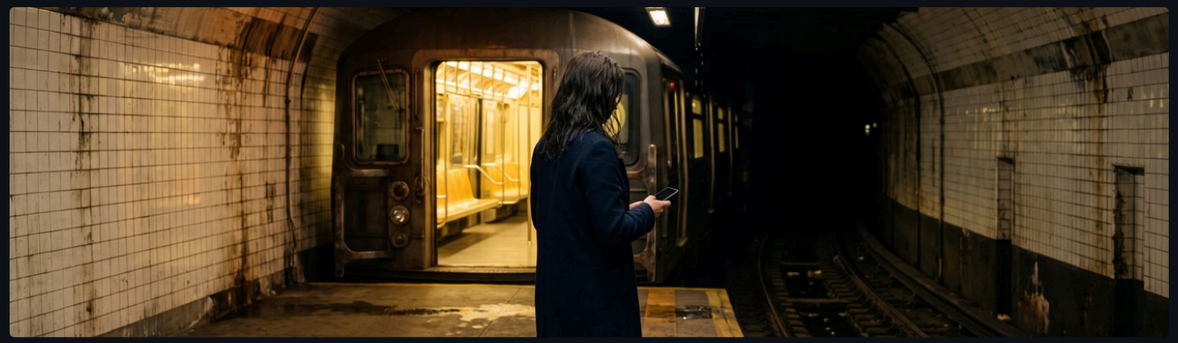
- Hair LOOSE, not tied (frame 02 shows a ponytail)
- Headset around the neck, single-ear (not clipped to the coat)
- No letters on the cyan sign



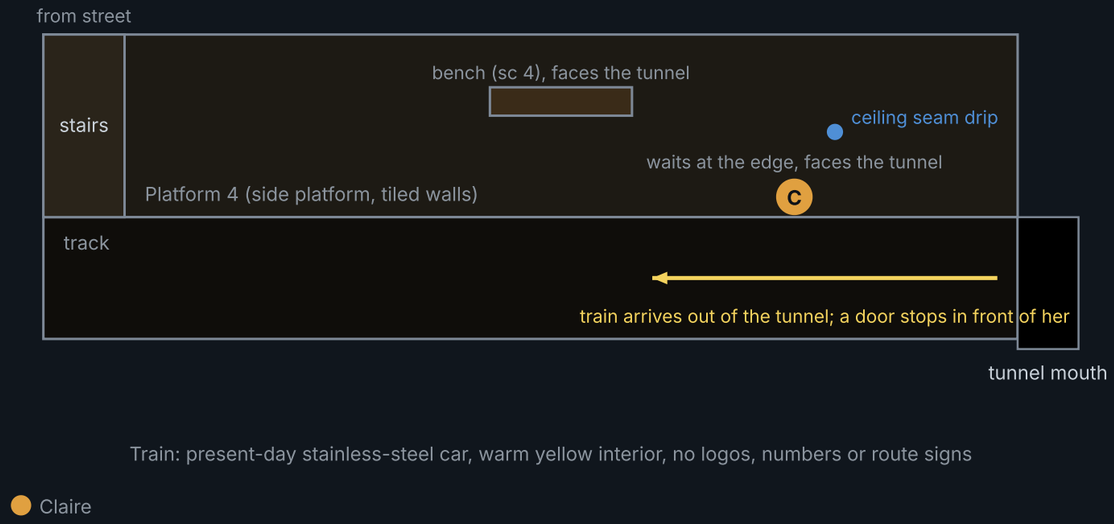
Building	Older concrete civic building, renovated glass doors, a deep concrete canopy. Dry under it.
Across the street	The subway entrance kiosk, screen right, its cyan sign blank. Her eyeline goes to it.
Claire	Look B, dry: navy coat, collar down, headset around her neck, phone from coat pocket to RIGHT palm.

Subway Platform 4 + the train

SCENES 3 · 4 APPROVED 4 OCT







FIX FROM THE MOOD FRAME

- Frame 03's car drifted to a specific older model: use the present-day stainless car
- Hair loose and damp, not a ponytail (frame 04)
- No readable platform signage: the '4' is a comp

Layout	Side platform, tiled walls, stairs from the street at one end, the tunnel mouth at the other. She waits at the edge facing the tunnel.
Train	Comes out of the tunnel toward her; a door stops in front of her. Present-day stainless-steel car, warm yellow interior (3200K), empty, no logos, numbers or route signs.
Bench	Midway along the platform, facing the tunnel (sc 4). The dripping ceiling seam is near her waiting spot.

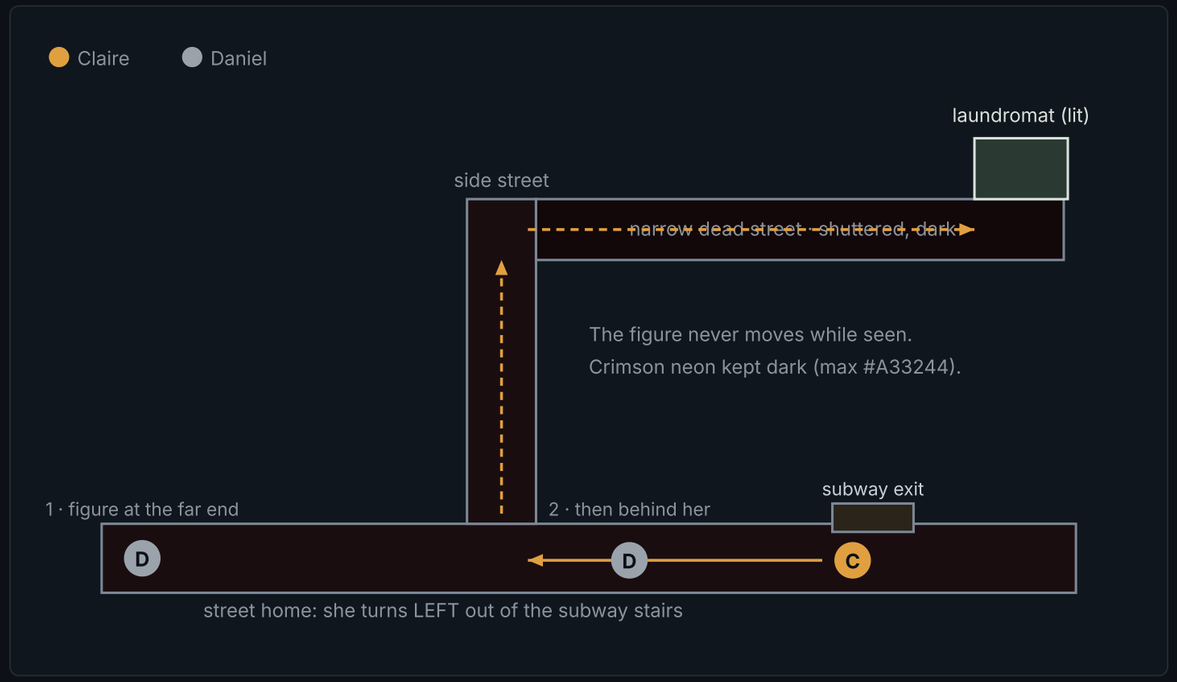
Downtown streets

SCENE 5 APPROVED 4 OCT



FIX FROM THE MOOD FRAME

- Daniel is front-lit with a shaved head: 'full head of short dark hair, no hat', 'backlit silhouette, face unreadable'
- Neon too pink and bright, with pseudo-letters: 'crimson kept dark', no letters
- Claire's coat: matte navy wool, not glossy



Route	Out of the subway, LEFT toward home · figure at the far end · sharp turn into a side street · figure behind her · narrower dead street · the lit laundromat.
Streets	Brick, steel roller shutters, dark windows, heavy rain on wet asphalt. Deep desaturated crimson neon, kept dark.
Figure	The long-gray-coat silhouette: far, still, backlit by a cool streetlight. Never moves while seen.

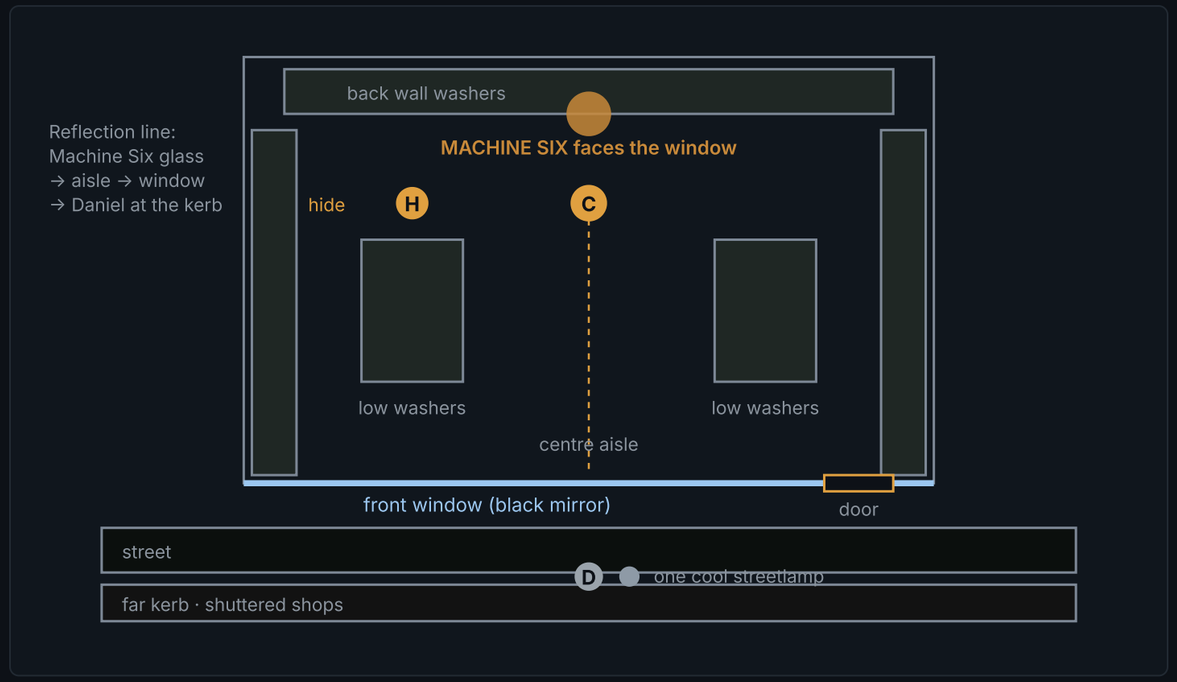
All-night laundromat + the street outside

SCENE 6 APPROVED 4 OCT



FIX FROM THE MOOD FRAME

- Add the amber drum glow (decided after the frame)
- No labels, numbers or panel glyphs on the machines (comp or keep soft)
- Earbud white, RIGHT ear



Layout	Symmetrical: washer rows along both side walls and a matching block of low washers on each side of the centre aisle. The door is at the RIGHT end of the front window (approved 4 Oct).
Machine Six	On the BACK wall, facing straight down the centre aisle to the front window. Its dark glass reflects the aisle, the window and the street behind her. Faint amber drum glow while it turns.
The beats	She enters by the door (front right) and walks the centre aisle to Machine Six; spins to the window; backs up until she knocks into Machine Six; three hurried steps; drops to the floor at the BACK of the left block of low washers (between it and the back wall washers): the block is between her and the window, in the corner farthest from the door.
Outside	Across the street: shuttered shops, one cool streetlamp. Daniel stands at the far kerb under it, in the rain. Through the window: black with a little neon.

Flooded avenue + the skyline with the Halcyon garage

SCENES 7 · 9 · 10 **DECIDED 4 OCT**



FIX FROM THE MOOD FRAME

- Claire in a hooded raincoat with bare legs: name the coat in full (navy matte wool, mid-thigh, no hood, no belt, dark trousers, flat black boots)
- It is an avenue with kerbs, cars and signs, not a lake
- No readable neon letters



LOCATIONS/SKYLINE WITH HALCYON GARAGE (SC7, 9, 10).PNG · GARAGE DESIGN REFERENCE

The garage	Raw concrete, built in the 1970s and still in use, 6 open decks lit pale cool-white, a glass-fronted stair tower on its LEFT corner as seen from the avenue. Plate v1 is the design reference (decided).
Geography	From the avenue and from the footbridge the garage is always ahead of her and slightly right, far off above the rooftops.
Final frame	The end of the scene 9 rising pull-back (high, looking down the flooded avenue to the garage far off) is designed in the shot list (step 5) and generated at step 7 (decided).
Not used	Plate v1's composition (garage at street level, wet not flooded) and retake 1 (copied it, plus a warm lamp).

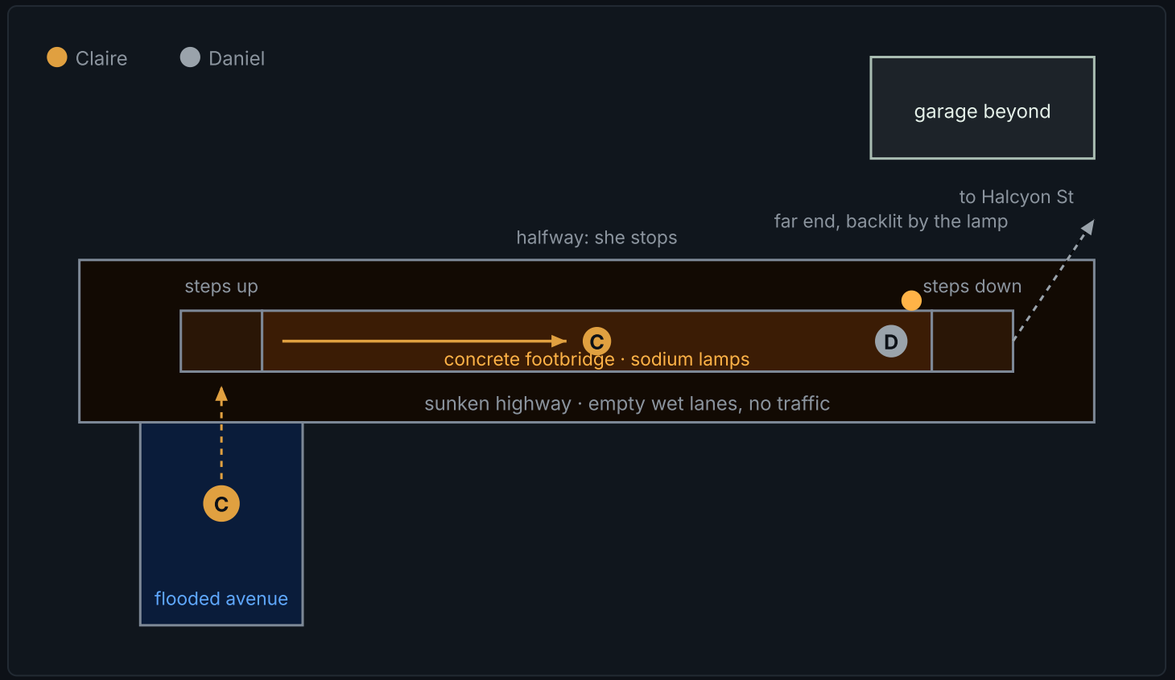
Halcyon footbridge

SCENE 10 · APPROVED 4 OCT



FIX FROM THE MOOD FRAME

- Daniel is at the near end, front-lit and bald: he is at the FAR end, backlit, full head of short dark hair
- Garage beyond must match plate v1 (stair tower on its left corner)



Layout	The flooded avenue ends at steps up to a concrete footbridge over a sunken highway. Far steps lead down toward Halcyon Street. The garage rises beyond, ahead and slightly right.
Beats	She climbs, stops halfway; the silhouette waits at the far end under the streetlamp; she looks back, then ahead; walks toward him; he turns, walks down the far steps.
Light	Monochrome sodium. The far-end lamp backlights Daniel. No traffic below, no blue fill.

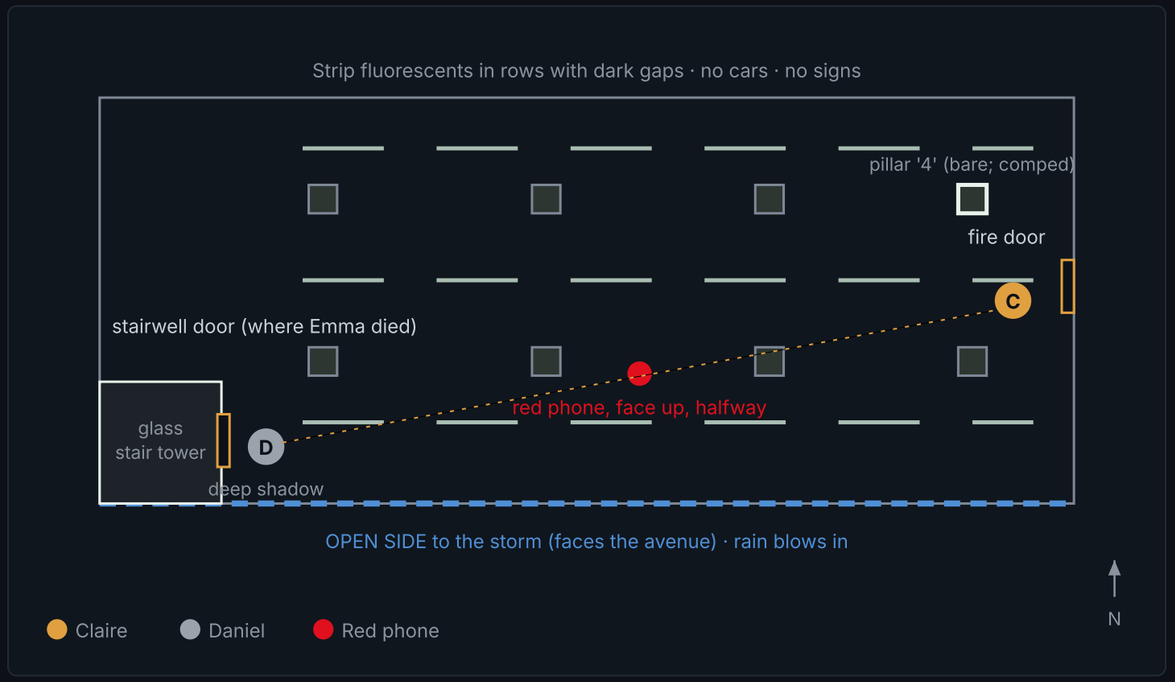
Halcyon Street garage, level four

SCENE 11 · APPROVED 4 OCT



FIX FROM THE MOOD FRAME

- Readable 'STAIRS' sign on the door: 'no signs on doors'
- Her coat came out glossy and belted: matte wool, no belt
- The red phone's screen glows too bright: 'screen glow dim'



Layout	A long rectangular level. She enters through the fire door at the east end; the stairwell door (inside the glass stair tower, where Emma died) is at the far west end. Facing Daniel, the open side to the storm is on her LEFT.
Marks	Pillar '4' nearest her, on her right (bare; the 4 is comped). The red phone lies face up halfway between them, in a pool of strip light.
Daniel	Deep shadow beside the stairwell door; steps forward into a strip for the reveal. Exits through that door.
Light	Rows of strip fluorescents with dark gaps, some flickering; puddles hold broken copies. No cars.

Police station lobby

SCENE 12 APPROVED 4 OCT



FIX FROM THE MOOD FRAME

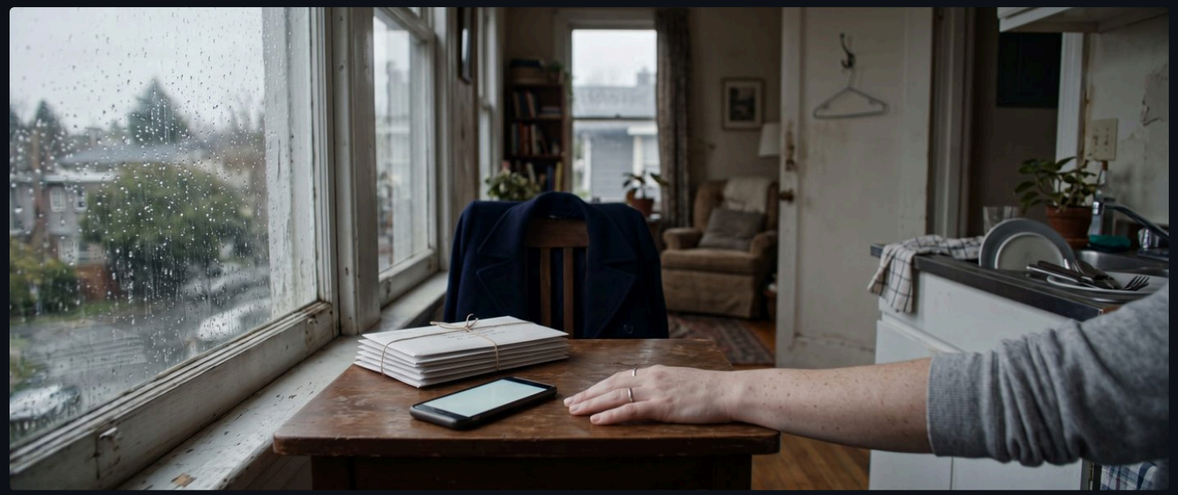
- Street outside reads suburban: 'city street, brick buildings'
- The headset became a two-ear model: 'black single-ear headset'
- Officer in a dark-navy uniform, not a black shirt; no badges



Layout	Glass entrance doors; rows of empty plastic chairs along one wall; the wooden front desk opposite, the officer behind it.
Counter	The red phone (cracked screen up) and the headset side by side, the first time the headset leaves her neck.
Outside	A wet, still CITY street: brick facades, gray sky. Not suburban.

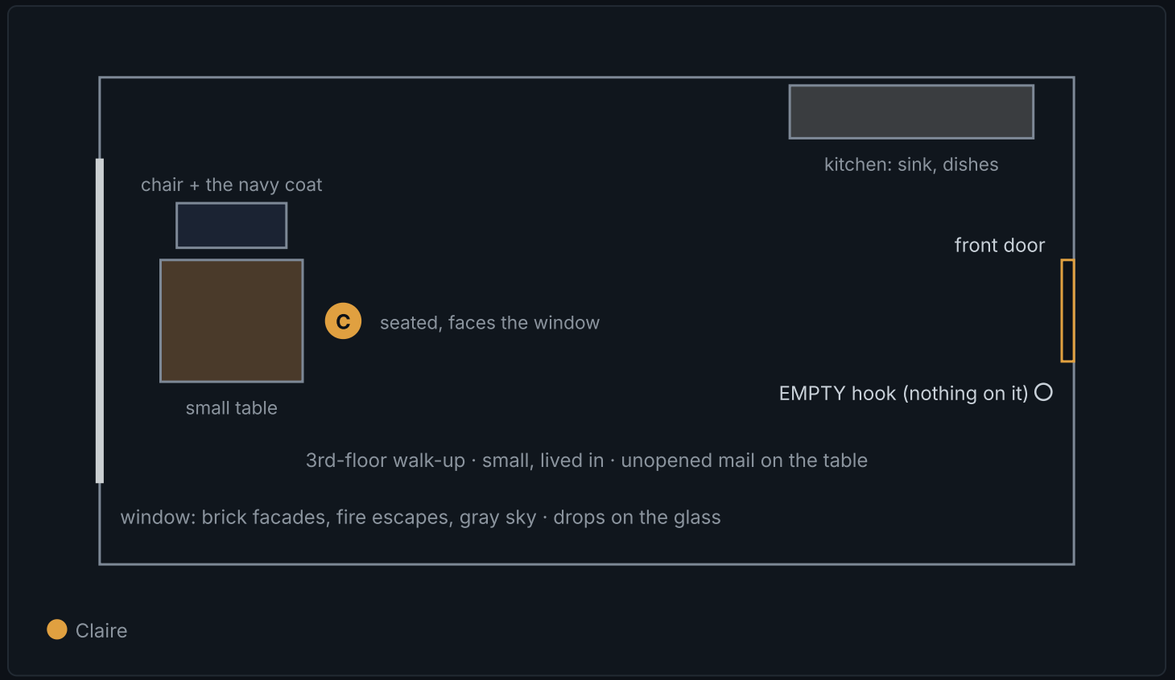
Claire's apartment

SCENE 13 APPROVED 4 OCT



FIX FROM THE MOOD FRAME

- A hanger is on the hook: 'bare empty wall hook, nothing on it'
- View reads suburban: brick facades and fire escapes
- Hand: copper-honey hair, gray knit sleeve



Layout	3rd-floor walk-up. A small table by the window; the navy coat over a chair; unopened mail; dishes in the sink; the front door with an empty hook.
Window	Brick facades and fire escapes opposite, a pale gray sky, drops on the glass.
Claire	Look E. Her free hand flat and still on the table. The phone on the table.

Carried into steps 5 and 7

STEP 5 · SHOT LIST

- Design the end frame of the scene 9 rising pull-back: high over the flooded avenue, the garage far off (decided)
- Use the approved layouts for every blocking and eyeline: Machine Six reflection line, garage pillar/phone/door marks, footbridge halfway stop
- Include the beats from the breakdown: phone pocketed on the subway stairs (sc 5), taken out on the footbridge (sc 10)

PROMPT RULE CHANGES

- Rule 1 (Claire's hair): replace 'blonde' with the copper-honey string on page 4, plus 'not red, not ginger'
- Faces: attach the locked face image and refer to 'the woman / man from the attached reference'
- Locations: add 'present-day', 'city street', and the fixes listed on each location page

STEP 7 · TESTS

- Claire's face: the scene 7 match-frame close-up (L7 blue rain), scene 8 (L8 amber, ponytail), scene 10 (L9 sodium)
- Her hair: copper under amber and green fluorescent, wet and dry
- Outfit builds of looks A, A-young, B, C, D, E on the locked face (castkit station 2)
- Daniel: backlit silhouette at 135 mm, and the 50 mm reveal in strip light
- The final skyline frame, and a garage level-four plate to the approved layout
- Credits: 7 remaining after step 4 (2 per Nano Banana Pro image at 2K)

Model note: all 7 casting/plate generations were billed as Nano Banana Pro; Higgsfield's job records label them Nano Banana 2. Worth checking in the Higgsfield history before step 7.